Get Certified Document your skills with W3Schools Certificates ~~$1,995~~ $699

JavaScript String Search

Previous Next

String Search Methods

String indexOf()
String lastIndexOf()
String search()
String match()
String matchAll()
String includes()
String startsWith()
String endsWith()

See Also:

String Tutorial
String Methods
String Templates
String Reference

JavaScript String indexOf()

The `indexOf()` method returns the **index** (position) of the **first** occurrence of a string in a string, or it returns -1 if the string is not found:

Example

```
let text = "Please locate where 'locate' occurs!";
let index = text.indexOf("locate");
```

Note

JavaScript counts positions from zero.

0 is the first position in a string, 1 is the second, 2 is the third, ...

JavaScript String lastIndexOf()

The `lastIndexOf()` method returns the **index** of the **last** occurrence of a specified text in a string:

Example

```
let text = "Please locate where 'locate' occurs!";
let index = text.lastIndexOf("locate");
```

Try it Yourself »

Both `indexOf()`, and `lastIndexOf()` return -1 if the text is not found:

Example

```
let text = "Please locate where 'locate' occurs!";
let index = text.lastIndexOf("John");
```

Try it Yourself »

Both methods accept a second parameter as the starting position for the search:

Example

```
let text = "Please locate where 'locate' occurs!";
let index = text.indexOf("locate", 15);
```

The `lastIndexOf()` methods searches backwards (from the end to the beginning), meaning: if the second parameter is `15`, the search starts at position 15, and searches to the beginning of the string.

Example

```
let text = "Please locate where 'locate' occurs!";
text.lastIndexOf("locate", 15);
```

Try it Yourself »

JavaScript String search()

The `search()` method searches a string for a string (or a regular expression) and returns the position of the match:

Examples

```
let text = "Please locate where 'locate' occurs!";
text.search("locate");
```

Try it Yourself »

```
let text = "Please locate where 'locate' occurs!";
text.search(/locate/);
```

Try it Yourself »

Did You Notice?

The two methods, `indexOf()` and `search()`, are **equal?**

They accept the same arguments (parameters), and return the same value?

The two methods are **NOT** equal. These are the differences:

ADVERTISEMENT
Unlock every paid feature
Explore now

JavaScript String match()

The `match()` method returns an array containing the results of matching a string against a string (or a regular expression).

Examples

Perform a search for "ain":

```
let text = "The rain in SPAIN stays mainly in the plain";
text.match("ain");
```

Try it Yourself »

Perform a search for "ain":

```
let text = "The rain in SPAIN stays mainly in the plain";
text.match(/ain/);
```

Try it Yourself »

Perform a global search for "ain":

```
let text = "The rain in SPAIN stays mainly in the plain";
text.match(/ain/g);
```

```
let text = "The rain in SPAIN stays mainly in the plain";
text.match(/ain/gi);
```

Try it Yourself »

Note

If a regular expression does not include the *g* modifier (global search), `match()` will return only the first match in the string.

Read more about regular expressions in the chapter JS RegExp.

JavaScript String matchAll()

The `matchAll()` method returns an iterator containing the results of matching a string against a string (or a regular expression).

Example

```
const iterator = text.matchAll("Cats");
```

Try it Yourself »

If the parameter is a regular expression, the global flag (g) must be set, otherwise a TypeError is thrown.

Example

```
const iterator = text.matchAll(/Cats/g);
```

Try it Yourself »

```
const iterator = text.matchAll(/Cats/gi);
```

Try it Yourself »

Notes

`matchAll()` is an ES2020 feature.

`matchAll()` does not work in Internet Explorer.

JavaScript String includes()

The `includes()` method returns true if a string contains a specified value.

Otherwise it returns `false`.

Examples

Check if a string includes "world":

```
let text = "Hello world, welcome to the universe.";
text.includes("world");
```

Try it Yourself »

Check if a string includes "world". Start at position 12:

```
let text = "Hello world, welcome to the universe.";
text.includes("world", 12);
```

Try it Yourself »

`includes()` is case sensitive.

`includes()` is an ES6 feature.

JavaScript String startsWith()

The `startsWith()` method returns `true` if a string begins with a specified value.

Otherwise it returns `false`:

Examples

Returns true:

```
let text = "Hello world, welcome to the universe.";
text.startsWith("Hello");
```

Try it Yourself »

Returns false:

```
let text = "Hello world, welcome to the universe.";
text.startsWith("world")
```

Try it Yourself »

A start position for the search can be specified:

Returns false:

```
let text = "Hello world, welcome to the universe.";
text.startsWith("world", 5)
```

Try it Yourself »

Returns true:

Try it Yourself »

Notes

`startsWith()` is case sensitive.

`startsWith()` is an ES6 feature.

JavaScript String endsWith()

The `endsWith()` method returns `true` if a string ends with a specified value.

Otherwise it returns `false`:

Examples

Check if a string ends with "Doe":

```
let text = "John Doe";
text.endsWith("Doe");
```

Try it Yourself »

Check if the 11 first characters of a string ends with "world":

```
let text = "Hello world, welcome to the universe.";
text.endsWith("world", 11);
```

Try it Yourself »

Notes

`endsWith()` is case sensitive.

Complete JavaScript Reference

For a complete reference to all JavaScript properties and methods, with full descriptions and many examples, go to:

W3Schools' Full JavaScript Reference.

The reference inludes all JavaScript updates from 1999 to 2025.

Exercise

Consider the following code:

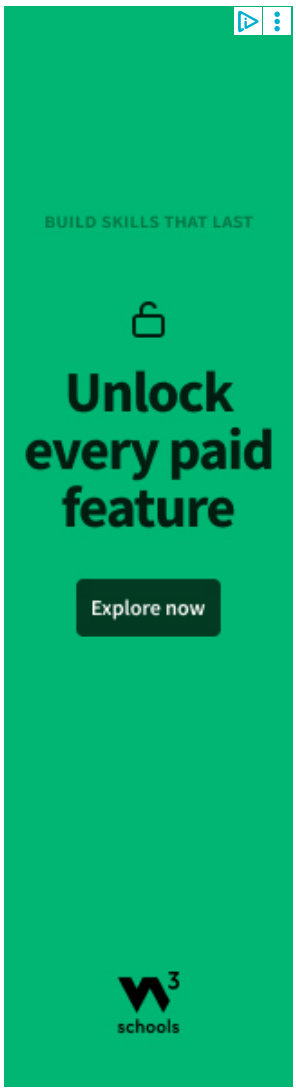
```
let x = 'Hello world!';
alert(x.indexOf('Hello'));
```

What will be the alerted result?

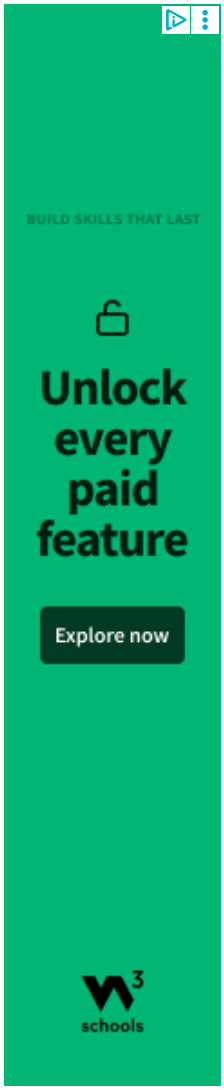
- -1
- 0
- 1
- true

Submit Answer »

ADVERTISEMENT



ADVERTISEMENT



ADVERTISEMENT

ADVERTISEMENT

Top Tutorials

HTML Tutorial
CSS Tutorial
JavaScript Tutorial
How To Tutorial
SQL Tutorial
Python Tutorial
W3.CSS Tutorial
Bootstrap Tutorial
PHP Tutorial
Java Tutorial
C++ Tutorial
jQuery Tutorial

Top References

HTML Reference
CSS Reference
JavaScript Reference
SQL Reference
Python Reference
W3.CSS Reference
Bootstrap Reference
PHP Reference
HTML Colors
Java Reference
Angular Reference
jQuery Reference

Top Examples

HTML Examples
CSS Examples

Get Certified

HTML Certificate
CSS Certificate

W3Schools is optimized for learning and training. Examples might be simplified to improve reading and learning. Tutorials, references, and examples are constantly reviewed to avoid errors, but we cannot warrant full correctness of all content. While using W3Schools, you agree to have read and accepted our terms of use, cookie and privacy policy.

Copyright 1999-2025 by Refsnes Data. All Rights Reserved. W3Schools is Powered by W3.CSS.